



VIGENÈRE'S VEIL

STUDY GUIDE

INGENIUM

INTRODUCTION

Somewhere between the letters, a message is waiting. Every cipher is a wall, and every wall has a crack. Vigenère's Veil is three rounds of finding it before the team next to you does. Think fast, work together, and keep your head when the clock gets louder than your own doubt.

This is not a category for the unprepared. Study the ciphers below. Know them cold.

General Notes

- This category consists of 3 rounds, held across the three days of the event.
- The decisions of the organisers are final.
- All rules outlined below are preliminary and may be adjusted before the event.

ROUND 1: RELAY RACE

Your team moves as one chain, and a chain is only as strong as its weakest link. Each delegate cracks their piece and passes it forward: decrypt, extract, hand off, then the next runner takes it from there. There's no time to double back. What you solve is what the next person has to work with, and what they solve decides how far your team gets. Speed matters. So does not breaking the chain.

Delegate cap: 3

ROUND 2: THE ESCAPE ROOM

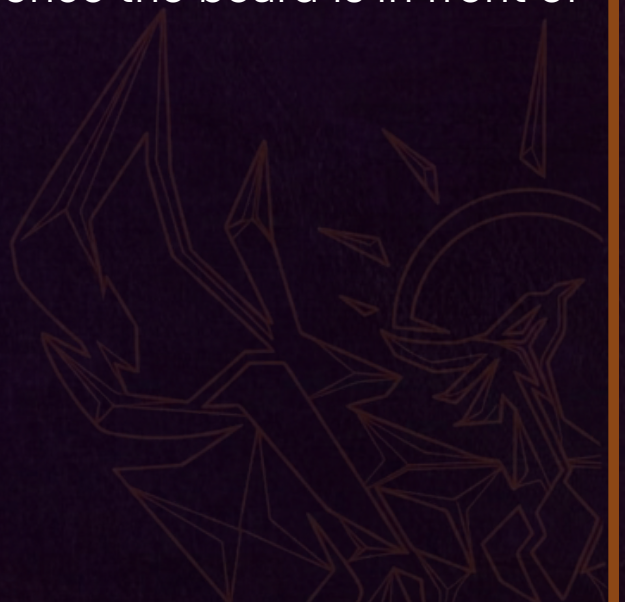
Locked doors don't open for the slow. Somewhere in this room is a way out, but the path there won't be handed to you. Every step forward has to be earned, and not everything you need is written in plain sight. Some of it you'll have to find yourselves, and know where to look before you can even begin. The clock doesn't wait for teams that hesitate. Neither does the room.

Delegate cap: 2

ROUND 3: MASTERMIND

The final stage is a duel: two teams, two hidden codes, one board between them. This round is built on the boardgame Mastermind. Every code you crack earns you the right to guess at your rival's, and every guess narrows the net a little further. Come knowing the game, not just the ciphers. The teams who've thought through their strategy in advance will have the edge once the board is in front of them.

Delegate cap: 2



CIPHERS YOU ARE REQUIRED TO KNOW

Atbash · Caesar · Vigenère · Playfair (I/J share a cell) · ADFGVX · Rail Fence · Route Cipher (spiral inward, clockwise) · Pigpen · Templar · Hexadecimal / Binary

